

Vehicle Grid Integration Council (VGIC) Informal Comments: Massachusetts Utilities' Draft Proposal for the Next Phase of Electric Vehicle Programs

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Introduction

The Vehicle Grid Integration Council (VGIC) appreciates the opportunity to provide informal feedback on the investor-owned utilities' draft Electric Vehicle (EV) Program proposals for 2027–2030. VGIC represents automakers, charging providers, and technology firms working to advance managed charging and bidirectional charging in support of an efficient, reliable, and decarbonized electric grid.

VGIC commends the utilities for their continued leadership in supporting transportation electrification and for their stated commitment to aligning EV programs with Massachusetts' clean energy and Zero-Emission Vehicle (ZEV) goals.

The next phase offers a timely opportunity to improve program coordination, enhance customer experience, and ensure that managed charging and bidirectional charging are positioned as core tools for achieving cost-effective grid integration.

Comments

Program Alignment and Participation:

- VGIC was pleased to see National Grid propose an “Enhanced” rebate for V2G systems. VGIC recommends that all utilities should **include a make-ready funding enhanced incentive for bidirectional charging installations for both the appropriate commercial use cases and residential program**, ensuring that bidirectional charging sites are supported equitably and consistently across Massachusetts service territories.
- Commercial non-exporting bidirectional charging systems should be made eligible for this enhanced make-ready funding incentive, given their significant potential to enhance energy resilience through grid-isolated backup power capabilities and customer savings via grid-parallel, *non-exporting* time-of-use (TOU) optimization and demand charge management.
- **Utilities should pursue greater alignment in both managed charging and make-ready program design** to simplify customer participation, enable consistent vendor engagement, and promote statewide scalability. Coordinated program structures will

reduce market confusion and facilitate participation by fleets and aggregators operating across territories.

- Managed charging programs will see greater success with **greater participation**. Programs should be designed to maximize customer participation across a variety of locations, including multi-unit dwellings, fleet depots, workplaces, beyond only single-family homes and a variety of enrollment pathways, including both EV and charging station. Programs should also consider options for integration with other DERs, including solar and batteries, to optimize grid benefits. Relatedly, VGIC discusses the policy seam between bidirectional charging and rooftop solar policy in more detail below.

Active and Passive Managed Charging:

- The proposal references both active and passive managed charging but provides little detail on the relative role, scale, or verification approach for each. **Utilities should clarify how active and passive program types will complement each other** and evolve over time.
- Programs should **clearly define, verify, and reward active managed charging that responds to system conditions in real- or day-ahead timeframes**, while ensuring that passive participation (e.g., off-peak rebates) continues to serve as an accessible on-ramp for customers.
- Active managed charging should be explicitly aligned with the ongoing grid services value work occurring in the state as discussed in the utilities Electric Sector Moderation Plans (ESMPs) referred to as “Bridge to Wires.” **This alignment will ensure that active managed charging program signals and incentive structures reflect locational and temporal grid needs.** Moreover, utilities should define, verify, and reward active managed charging programs that can optimize for the distribution system. Sustained customer engagement beyond the first year is critical to realizing long-term system benefits.
- VGIC supports utilities leveraging software-based platforms and third-party aggregators in delivering active managed charging services. These entities are crucial for achieving the scale and responsiveness required for effective grid management. Managed charging program design should therefore include clear pathways for the participation of aggregators, ensuring that they can enroll customers, manage charging events, and be compensated for the grid services they unlock.

Bidirectional Charging Technologies as a Core Program Element:

- **Bidirectional charging should be treated as a core component of the next-phase EV programs** around which the utilities plan holistically. This is critical as a new wave of

commercially available bidirectional EVs and chargers enters the market in the coming year, creating a timely opportunity for Massachusetts utilities to position their programs to support early adoption at a meaningful scale. Furthermore, utilities will have the benefit of early learnings from the MassCEC V2X Pilot Program to incorporate into the formation of their bidirectional charging programs.

- As utilities develop benefit-cost methodologies and future managed charging programs, it will be important to plan for durable, standardized compensation pathways for export-based resources, including bidirectional EV charging. Current participation in demand response programs such as Connected Solutions provides an important near-term value stream for V2G deployments, but utilities should develop a roadmap for long-term, standardized V2G export compensation, at both residential and commercial sites, aligned with the objectives of the Electric Sector Modernization Plans (ESMP) and broader grid modernization efforts. This will ensure that bidirectional charging remains a viable and scalable grid resource as programs and technology evolve, while also providing greater certainty for customers and site developers. Currently, it is challenging for customers and site developers to underwrite relatively large upfront investments in bidirectional charging sites as Connected Solutions must be renewed by the regulator every five years, which means revenue cannot be forecasted with a high degree of certainty beyond five years. The utilities should consider evolving the framework toward one that offers more certainty for customers and, in turn, spurs greater investment in bidirectional charging equipment.
- **Utilities should establish and clearly communicate streamlined interconnection, metering (i.e., for customer with rooftop solar), and predictable compensation pathways** for bidirectional charging system participation between 2027–2030 and design program rules that enable customers to transition seamlessly between managed charging and bidirectional charging.
- Coordinated participation frameworks should ensure that customers, aggregators, and technology providers can enroll in both managed charging and grid-service offerings **without duplicative hardware requirements, conflicting eligibility rules, or overlapping incentives**. Coordination should extend across program administration, data exchange, and performance verification to simplify customer experience, reduce administrative costs, and ensure that the grid value from managed charging and bidirectional charging resources is accurately measured and compensated.
- **Utilities should proactively address policy and program seams, including how EV exports interact with solar net energy metering policies**, to ensure consistent treatment of bidirectional resources and prevent barriers that could limit participation or value realization if not addressed in the program design phase. Notably, other jurisdictions have made progress on these types of interrelated issues. VGIC offers itself as a resource

to the utilities to develop pragmatic solutions that are best suited for Massachusetts' utilities.

Transparency and Policy Evolution:

- **Program data such as enrollment, performance, and grid value metrics should be publicly reported on an annual basis** to support stakeholder evaluation, inform rate design, and guide future planning. Transparent data access, supported by standard practices and privacy protections, will allow market participants to innovate and expand participation across utility territories.
- **Utilities should integrate strategies that support future scale-up of the VGI ecosystem**, such that the maximum possible number of customers can enroll in the programs they wish to enroll in.

Conclusion

VGIC appreciates the utilities' openness to stakeholder input as they shape the next phase of Massachusetts' EV programs. The state has an opportunity to build on its strong foundation by advancing a cohesive framework that fully integrates managed and bidirectional charging as grid resources and keeps program participation open to a variety of technologies and locations. Clear program alignment, transparent data practices, and readiness for a rapidly expanding market of bidirectional charging systems will ensure these programs deliver lasting benefits to customers and the electric system. VGIC looks forward to continued collaboration with the utilities to refine program design and implementation details ahead of the December filing.

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